

Alex Rivera

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SUMMARY

Platform-minded software engineer with 5+ years shipping ownership systems, GraphQL services, and reliable product infrastructure. Comfortable owning ambiguous problems end-to-end — from schema design and auth to billing, observability, and mentoring junior engineers.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Orbit Systems

- **Senior Product Engineer**

Full-time

San Francisco, CA

Mar 2024 – Present

- **Platform:** Led GraphQL federation across 6 services, cutting p95 API latency by 33% and removing two hand-rolled BFF layers.
- **Ownership:** Built role-aware onboarding used by 40+ PMs; cut time-to-first-insight from 2 weeks to 2 days.
- **Billing:** Shipped self-serve plan changes with Stripe webhooks, reducing billing support tickets 18%.
- **Mentorship:** Ran weekly design reviews for 3 engineers; introduced RFC template now used org-wide.

- **Product Engineer**

Full-time

San Francisco, CA

Jan 2022 – Feb 2024

- **Realtime:** Designed websocket fan-out for collaborative boards serving 12k concurrent editors.
- Migrated auth to session + OAuth with audit logs; closed 14 high-severity findings from pen test.
- Partnered with design on empty-state and error UX that lifted activation 9%.

Fieldnote

- **Software Engineer**

Full-time

Remote

Jun 2020 – Dec 2021

- **Dashboards:** Shipped role-aware OKR dashboards for enterprise customers across 3 plan tiers.
- **CI:** Cut flaky E2E failures 60% with quarantine + shard retries; preview deploys under 8 minutes.
- Built CSV import pipeline processing 2M rows/night with idempotent upserts.

Northwind Labs

- **Software Engineering Intern**

Internship

Berkeley, CA

May 2019 – Aug 2019

- Prototyped document search with Elasticsearch; improved internal findability for 200+ research notes.
- Added typed API clients and snapshot tests for the Python data-service SDK.

SKILLS

- **Languages:** TypeScript, Python, SQL, Go, HTML/CSS
- **Frontend:** React, Next.js, Tailwind, Vite, Storybook
- **Backend & Data:** Node.js, GraphQL, PostgreSQL, Redis, Prisma, Kafka
- **Cloud & Ops:** AWS, Docker, Terraform, GitHub Actions, Datadog, Sentry
- **Practices:** System design, RFCs, mentorship, incident response, accessibility

PROJECTS

- **Ledger Lite:** Next.js, PostgreSQL, Stripe, Playwright; Personal finance tracker with shared budgets, receipt OCR, and household permissions.; Open-sourced import adapters for Mint and CSV banks; 1.2k GitHub stars. Links: [GitHub](#), [Website](#), [Website](#)
- **Schema Garden:** Go, PostgreSQL, React; Visual schema explorer for Postgres with diff previews and safe migration suggestions. Links: [GitHub](#), [Website](#)

EDUCATION

University of California, Berkeley

B.S. Computer Science

Berkeley, CA

Aug 2016 – May 2020